Unit 1 Referencing, Quotation and Citation Processes

Introduction

When writing an essay or any other piece of academic work, you will need to show all documents that you have referred to. These may include books, journals, newspaper articles, websites, television programmes, films and so on. Academic writing usually involves commenting on, comparing and contrasting other people's work. It therefore, follows that you must cite references carefully and accurately so that readers can locate them. It is the purpose of this unit to equip you with referencing and citation skills. The unit emphasises the importance of acknowledging information that you use in writing different types of academic papers. It also explains the different methods of presenting information and provides examples of how different materials can be cited. We hope that after studying this unit, you will be able to effectively cite in all your sources of information.

Areas of emphasis

- definition of a citation
- differences between reference and bibliography
- styles of citation
- distinctive features of APA style of citation



Key words

- citation, documenting, bibliography, reference, APA, MLA, CMS, reference,
- publication information, superscript, entry, et al

Prerequisite knowledge

As a university student, you have used materials written by different people. Most of them contain a list showing all sources the author consulted in writing his or her document. This knowledge is very important and it will assist you to easily understand this unit.



Learning outcomes

By the end of this unit, you should be able to:

- define the term citation
- distinguish between references and bibliography

- use APA styles inside your academic works and at the of the essay
- describe main feature of APA style of citation
- cite information sourced from different materials.

Resources needed

- text books written by one author, two authors and more than five authors
- pens and sheets of paper
- any newspapers, journals, magazines and films

1.1 Referring to sources of information

When writing an academic paper, you are not necessarily expected to present previously unknown information on any topic rather you are expected to express your *own ideas* on already available information or views already expressed by others. This process is referred to as referencing. Referencing is citing, acknowledging or giving credit to sources of the information on which you are expressing your own opinion in your essay. In academic writing, you must always cite your sources of information.

Reasons for referencing or documenting information

There are a number of reasons for referencing information. Some of them are:

- to avoid plagiarism, i.e. using someone else's ideas as if they were your own. In other words, plagiarism is stealing some one's ideas or words. This is a very serious offence in academic writing and can land you onto punishments like disqualification.
- to facilitate development of ideas and scientific discoveries in all academic disciplines. This is so because information from experts can be used as a yardstick in dealing with different issues as well as in presenting theories that can help solve different problems.
- to make your material authentic and reliable.
- to give the reader a chance to read more on the subject, or to inspect your source for themselves.

1.2 Knowing what material requires acknowledging

It is important to appreciate that not all material requires acknowledging. For instance, when you are writing about issues of common knowledge, you are not supposed to cite the source. For example, if you are in Malawi, you are not required to cite the fact that Mzuzu is one of the cities. What you would cite is when you want to name the date when Mzuzu was declared a city. Similarly, if you were to say that Nyasaland was a British protectorate until 1964 or Muluzi was elected president in 1994. You do not need to cite

this information. But if you gave the total number of votes that Muluzi won in the 1994 Parliamentary and General Elections, then you must cite the source of the figures so that others can verify whether what you are saying is correct or wrong.

Apart from issues of common knowledge, you are also not required to cite well known facts. For instance, you do not need to attribute the fact that Britain was one of the countries that fought the Slave Trade. But you must acknowledge the source of an argument that Britain fought the Slave Trade because she wanted to replace it with a more profitable and more convenient trade in raw materials.

The following are examples of materials that require to be acknowledged:

- Direct quotations: whenever you use someone's words, even if it is just a phrase, put quotation marks around it and acknowledge the source.
- Facts that are not widely known such as statistics and can be questioned by other people.
- Judgements or opinions of others. Whenever you present another person's opinion, even if you paraphrase it, you must cite the source of the opinion.
- Statistics, charts, tables, diagrams and graphs must all be acknowledged if they do not originate from your own field research. Even when a chart or a graph is your own, you must acknowledge the source.
- To acknowledge the sources of all specific information, be it from primary or secondary source.



Activity 1

1 Define the term referencing.
2 State any three reasons for documenting materials.
3 Using one example in each case, distinguish common knowledge from well-known fact.
4 Why may it be necessary to cite the sources of opinions and judgements?

1.3 Presenting source material in your text

There are two ways of presenting your source material - within the text and at the end of the text. Whatever method you employ, remember that weaving other people's ideas into your writing can be challenging. The challenge is to use the sources and yet remain the author of your essay. It is imperative to see to it that while incorporating other voices, your voice still remains the single, dominant voice in your essay.

The following are a number of methods you must use when you are presenting source material in your essay:

1.3.1 Using paraphrases

When you are using this method, make sure that you restate the material in your own words. In other words, you express what somebody had said or written especially in order to make the original point easier to understand.

Paraphrasing is used when you want to use other people's ideas or information in detail but you feel there is no need for you to quote them verbatim. It is ideal when you want to present other people's background information or other facts your readers may not already know. Besides, you paraphrase when you want to present other people's ordinary views (i.e. not impressive and not striking views).

1.3.2 Using summaries

Summaries refer to short statements that give only the main points of something not details. Therefore in your citation, you use summaries when you want to present in brief only the general idea of large amounts of information from other people.

1.3.3 Using direct quotations

A quotation refers to a group of words taken from a book, play, speech, etc. and repeated because it is useful. Nevertheless, remember that your essay must be in your own words. You should not depend much on other people's words. You should also avoid over-quoting in your essay. Only quote:

- A statement expressed so effectively by the author that it cannot be paraphrased without altering its meaning.
- To allow words of an author (expert) to strengthen your argument.

In your text, the quoted sentence of fewer than 40 words should always appear in double quotation marks. However, display a quotation of more than 40 words in a free-standing block and omit quotation marks. Start such a *block quotation* on a new line, indented five spaces from the left margin. Type the entire quotation double-spaced on the new margin and leave space or a line before any subsequent paragraphs.

The following examples illustrate the application of American Psychological Association (APA) style to direct quotation of a source:

Quotation 1

He stated that, "many people catch the virus willingly not ignorantly because of their failure to exercise self-control" (Smith, 2002, p. 200).

Quotation 2

Smith (2002) found that "many people catch the virus willingly not ignorantly because of their failure to exercise self-control" (p. 200).

Quotation 3

Smith (2002) found the following:

> Many people catch the virus willingly not ignorantly because of their failure to exercise self-control. This is particularly true amongst the youths who spend much of their time talking about sexual issues, watch pornographic films as well as read materials that arouse them. By the end of the day, because these people do not have reliable girl friends they end up hooking prostitutes with whom they engage in unsafe sex. Sadly, instead of changing, this trend persists. As a result, many youths are dying prematurely leaving behind old parents in need of support. (p.200)

You can place a quotation anywhere in your text: at the beginning of a paragraph, in the middle or at the end of a paragraph.



Activity 2

1 What is the difference between a paraphrase and a summary?
2 In what circumstances do you use a quotation?
3 Take any newspaper of your choice, read three paragraphs and write:
    a) a summarised version of the three paragraphs.
    b) a paraphrase of the three paragraphs.
4 Read a paragraph in any book and present short and long quotations from that paragraph.

1.4 Styles of documenting information in your text

There are a number of referencing styles and some are simple to use while others are hard. Preference on which style to use is dependent on the institution in question and it may vary from place to place. In this unit, we will discuss American Psychological Association (APA), Modern Language Association (MLA) and Chicago Manual of Styles. At Mzuzu University, we recommend APA style of citation.

1.4.1 The American Psychological Association (APA) style of documentation Style

This style, in most cases, resembles the Harvard System of referencing save for a few distinctive features. The APA style presents sources in parentheses. As a result, in most cases it is commonly known as The APA style for parenthetical citation. All quotations, paraphrases, summaries and other material from other sources are documented within the text of your paper. Generally, the APA format does not use foot notes and is often favoured by people because of its simplicity. There is no need to re-order and re-number references as it happens with other styles.

1.4.2 How to use the APA format for parenthetical citations

When using APA parenthetical citation observe the following features:

- Parenthetical citations correspond to full bibliographic entries in a list of references at the end of the text.
- Generally, the author's name is used in a signal phrase to introduce the cited material, and the date, in parentheses, immediately follows the author's name.
- For a quotation, the page number, preceded by ***p.***, appears in parentheses after the quotation.

Let us now look at some examples of citations for various kinds of sources

Author named in signal phrase

David (2003) argues that many women are unfairly discriminated against contesting in parliamentary seats.

As Briggs (1970) observes, parents play an important role in building their children's self-esteem because "children value themselves to the degree that they have been valued" (p. 14).

Author named in parenthetical citation

When you do not name the author in your text, give the name and the date, separated by a comma, in parentheses at the end of the cited material.

One study has found that 68 % of people working as sex workers in the Northern Region of Malawi are HIV positive (Phiri, 2000).

Two authors

Use both names in all citations. Join the names with *and* in a signal phrase, but use the abbreviated and (&) instead in a parenthetical reference.

Murphy and Orkow (1985) reached somewhat different conclusions by designing a study that was less dependent on subjective judgement than were previous studies.

A recent study that was less dependent on subjective judgement resulted in conclusions somewhat different from those of previous studies (Murphy & Orkow, 1985).

Three to five authors
List all the authors' names in a signal phrase or parenthetical citation for the first reference.

Banda, Chirwa, Gondwe, Phiri, and Zgambo (2000) suggest that many women rely on observing and listening to others as ways of learning about themselves.

In any subsequent references, use just the first author's name (if we consider our example then use Banda) plus *et al* which means and others. Note that all the author's names should appear in the entry list of references.

As a result of this, observe Chirwa et al. (2000), women learn to listen to themselves then take a step toward self expression.

Six or more authors
If a book has been written by six or more authors, use only the first author's name and *et al.* ('' and others") in every citation, including the first. Note that all the authors' names should appear in the entry in the list of references. For example:

As Muller et al. (1980) demonstrated, television holds the potential for distorting and manipulating people as free-willed viewers.

Corporate or group author
When you are using a book authored by a group of authors, spell out the name each time you cite it.
If the name is long, spell it out the first time you use it, followed by an abbreviation in brackets. In later citations, use the abbreviation only. For example:

First citation
(The Malawi Broadcasting Corporation [MBC], 1990)

Later citation
(MBC, 1990)

Unknown author
Sometimes it is possible to retrieve information from a source whose author is anonymous. In this case, use the title or its first few words in a signal phrase or parenthetical citation. For example:

The school profiles for the Division substantiates this trend (Guide to Secondary Schools 1983)

Specific parts of a source
If you want to cite specific parts of a source such as a chapter or section, use abbreviations (*chap., p.,* and so on) in parenthetical citation to name the part you are citing.

Montgomery (1988, chap. 9) argues that his research yielded the opposite results.

Personal communication
Cite any personal letters, memos, e-mail, telephone conversations, interviews and etc, with person's initial(s) and last name, the identification personal communication, and the date. Because your readers would probably not be able to locate these sources, you need not include them in your list of references. Look at the example below:

J. L. Morin (personal communication, October 14, 1990) supported the claims made in her recent article with new evidence.



Activity 3

1 Briefly describe the main features of APA style of citation and provide examples to support your description.

1.4.3 APA format for a list of references

Before we consider the format for arranging references when you are using APA style, it is important to appreciate the differences between reference and bibliography.

References refer to the alphabetical list of the sources cited in your essay. On the other hand, *bibliography* is a list of everything you have read as background for your essay. References should capture only those materials actually cited in your paper where as a bibliography will contain both cited and uncited material. The terms bibliography and reference may be used the other way round when you are dealing with other styles of citation.

When you are writing references or bibliography make sure that you follow these:

- Start your list on a separate page after the text of your essay but before any appendices that explain your research procedures or results and any notes.
- Continue the consecutive numbering of pages.
- Type the heading 'References,' neither underlined nor in quotation marks, centred on top of the page.
- Double-space and begin your first entry.
- Do not indent the first line of each entry, but indent any subsequent lines of the entry five spaces.
- Double-space the entire list.
- List your sources alphabetically (i.e. from A to Z) by author's last names.
- If the source is anonymous author, alphabetise it by the first major word of the title.

The APA style specifies treatment and placement of four basic elements - author, publication date, title, and publisher information. These are integral parts and every time you are writing academic papers ensure that you have used them appropriately. Let us now look at these four basic elements in detail:

Author

List all authors last name first, and use only initials for first and middle names. Separate the names of multiple authors with commas and use an ampersand (abbreviated 'and') before the last author's name. For example, Banda, L., & Phiri, K.

Publication date

Enclose the date in parentheses (brackets). Use only the year for books and journals, use the year, a comma, and the month or month and day for magazines. Do not abbreviate the month.

Title

Underline titles (or italicise titles) and subtitles of books and periodicals. Do not enclose titles of articles in quotation marks. For books and articles capitalise only the first word of the title and subtitle and any proper nouns or proper adjectives.

Publication information

For a book, list the city of publication (and the country or postal abbreviation for the state if the city is unfamiliar), a colon, and the publisher's name, dropping any *Inc., Co., or Publishers.* For a periodical, follow the periodical title with a comma, the volume number, the issue number (if appropriate) in parentheses, a comma and the inclusive page

numbers of the article. For newspapers, include the abbreviations *p.* (''page") or *pp.* ("pages").

Let us now look at how different materials are presented in a bibliography or reference:

Books
Book by one author
Wakuda, M. (1993) *Politics in Malawi.* Blantyre: Longman

Book by two or more authors
Banda, M., & Maulidi, W. (2008) *Piracy in Malawi.* Harare: Longman

Book by a corporate or group author
Institute of Financial Education. (2001) *Income Property Lending in Malawi.* Zomba: Kachere Series.

Book by an unknown author
National Geographic Atlas of the World. (1988). Washington, DC: National Geographic Society.

Books prepared by an editor
Soja, A.P. (Ed.). (2006) *The Famous City.* Cambridge: MIT Press.

Selection in a book
West, C. (1992) The post-modern crisis of the black intellectuals. In L. Grossberg, C. Nelson, & P. Treichler (Eds.), *Cultural Studies* (pp.589-705). New York: Routledge.

Translation
Durkeim, E. (1957). *Suicide* (J.A. Spaulding & G Simpson, Trans.). Glencoe, IL: Free Press of Glencoe.

One volume of a multi-volume work
Baltes, P., & Brim, O.G. (Eds.). (1980) *Life-span Development and Behaviour* (Vol.3). New York: Basic Books.

Republication
Piaget, J. (1952) *The Language and Thought of the Child.* London: Routledge & Kegan Paul. (Original work published in 1932).

Government publication

U.S Bureau of the Census. (1975) *Historical Statistics of the United States, colonial times to 1870.* Washington, DC: U.S. Government Printing Office.

Periodicals

Article in a journal paginated by volume

Banda, R. (1981) A holistic view of language. Research in the Teaching of English, 15, 101-111

Article in a journal paginated by issue

Malenza, J.G. (1986) The Superintendence: Characteristics for Men and Women. Educational Administration Quarterly, 22 (4), 1-8

Article in a magazine

Gralla, P. (1994, April) How to Cyberspace. PC Computing, 60-62

Article in a newspaper

Banda, M. (2002, April 26) Murder in the Park. The Daily Times, pp 2-4

Unsigned article

What sort of person reads creative computing? (1985, August). Creative Computing, 8, 10.

Editorial or letter to the editor

Russell, J.S. (1994, March 27) The Language Instinct [Letter to the editor]. The New York Times Book Review, 27.

Review

Larmore, C.E. (1989). (Review of the book: Patterns of Moral Complexity*)*. Ethics, 99, 423-426.

Published interview

McCarthy, E. (1968, December 24) [Interview with Boston Globe: Washngton staff]. Boston Globe, p.B27.

Order of references in the reference list

Alphabetising names

Arrange entries in alphabetical order by the surname of the first author. Surnames that use articles and prepositions (de, la, du, von, wa, van etc) are alphabetised according to different rules for different languages. If you know that the prefix is commonly part of

the surname (e.g. De Blij) treat the prefix as part of the last name and alphabetise by the prefix.

Order of several works by the same first author
When ordering several works by the same first author, give the authors name in the first and all subsequent references and use the following rules to arrange the entries:

Single-author entries precede multiple-author entries beginning with the same surname:
Banda, J.R. (1981)
Banda, J.R., & Gama, D.F. (1978)

References with the same first author and different second or third authors are arranged alphabetically by the surname of the second author and so on:
Banda, J.R., Chirwa, K, & Gondwe, D.F. (1982)
Banda, J.R., & Phiri, D.F. (1978)

References with the same authors in the same order are arranged in chronological order by year of publication, the earliest first:
Banda, J.R., & Gama, D.F. (1978)
Banda, J.R., & Gama, D.F. (1982)

References by the same author (or by the same two or more authors in the same order) with the same publication date are arranged alphabetically (excluding A or The).

Exception: *if references with the same authors published in the same year are identified as articles in a series e.g. Part 1 and Part 2), order the references in the series order, not alphabetically by title. Lower case letters- a, b, c, and so on- are placed immediately after the year, within the parentheses:*
Banda, J.R., & Gama, D.F. (1980a). Control of...
Banda, J.R., & Gama, D.F. (1980b). Roles of...

Works by different authors with the same surname are arranged alphabetically by the first initial:
Banda, A.R. (1983)
Banda, J.R. (1980)

Order of works with corporate authors or with no authors
Occasionally a work will have as its author an agency, association or institution, or it will have no author at all. Alphabetise corporate authors, such as associations or government agencies, by the first significant word of the name. Full official names should be used

(e.g. Mzuzu University, not Mzuni). A parent body precedes a subdivision (e.g. Mzuzu University, Department of Forestry).

If and only if the work is signed *"Anonymous"* the entry begins with the word 'anonymous' spelled out, and the entry is alphabetised as if anonymous were a true name.

If there is no author, the title moves to the author position and the entry is alphabetised by the first significant word of the title.

1.5 Modern Language Association (MLA) style of citation

The Modern Language Association (MLA) style is often used for citations in the humanities. English, art, and film papers, usually use MLA format, as well as most High School teachers.

MLA bibliographical entries

MLA format often utilises a split method of crafting a bibliography. The first half will be a works cited page, in which you list every source you cited within your text. Everything you quoted or paraphrases within your paper will go here with page numbers. The second half is the Works Consulted page, in which you list every other source used to compile your paper in research. Together they form a MLA bibliography.
Bibliographical entries are listed in alphabetical order by the last name of the author. If you go beyond a single line for one entry, indent the second and subsequent lines.

Books

The most basic kind of bibliographical entry is that of a book. For years, most research has been done in books and most of your teachers today, regardless of the amount of internet information available to you, will require book research. Use the following format for entering a book into your bibliography:
Author (last name first). Title of the book. City: Publisher, Date of publication.
Example:
Rowling, J.K. Harry Potter and the Sorcerer's Stone. New York: Scholastic, 1998.
In the case of an encyclopedia, your entry will be slightly different. Use the following:
Encyclopedia Title, Edition Date. Volume Number, "Article Title," page numbers.
Example:
The Encyclopedia Britannica, 1997. Volume 7, "Gorillas," pp. 50-51.

Magazine and journal articles

Magazines and journals are often used in topical papers for quoting information you cannot find in an encyclopedia or printed book. Citing a magazine is slightly different

from a book however. Use the following format for entering a magazine or journal entry into your bibliography:
Author's Last Name, First Name. "Article Title: Subtitle." Periodical Title, Volume (year): inclusive page numbers.
Example:
Scelfo, Julie. "Accident's Will Happen: ATVs are cool to ride, but thousands of kids are getting hurt, and some are dying." Newsweek May 14, 2007: 59.
Note that the second line of the entry is indented. All bibliographical entries that go beyond a single line must be indented thereafter.

Newspapers
Similar to Journal and Magazine entries, though slightly different, the following should be used for Newspaper entries:
Author (last name first), "Article Title." Name of newspaper, city, and state of publication. (Date): edition if available, section, page number(s).
Example:
Finder, Alan, "Ivy League Crunch Brings New Cache to Next Tier." The New York Times, New York, NY. (5/16/07): Atlantic Region, Front Page, 1.

Electronic sources
We must accept the fact that many of the sources used today for research are online. For this reason, electronic or online sources make up more and more of bibliographies. They also have a very specific format. It is important to remember that electronic entries are often harder to gather information on. If you cannot find all of the necessary information from a website to enter in your bibliography, simply skip the step that you cannot complete and go to the next.
Because internet documents are so easily moved or changed, it's necessary to include as much information as you can gather. So, if a document online was originally a print document, be sure to first include the print information for that source. Use the above formats for books and magazine articles.
After print information (or if there is no print information) include as much electronic information as possible. This information should include the Title of the site you navigated, the date of publication or most recent update, and the organisation or group sponsoring the website.
Finally, include all of the information pertinent to when you accessed the site itself. This includes the date you visited the site and the URL of the website (URL formatting should be done between <> brackets and with no added hyphens, breaks, or gaps).
Here is an example of a print source reproduced online:

Author's Last Name, First Name. "Title of the Document." Title of Journal or book. Print publication information. Title of site. Date of electronic publication or last update. Name of organisation or Institution. Date of Access.
For the use of a professional or personal website without previously published material, use the following:
Creator's last name, first name. Title of the site. Description of the page. Organisation associated with the site. Date of electronic publication, copyright, or date accessed or last date updated.

Other examples
Occasionally, you'll use other, less common sources for your paper such as films or interviews. In those cases, you still must cite your sources using the following format:

Film
Title, Director, Distributor, Year

Interview
Full name (last name first). Occupation. Date of interview.

1.6 Chicago Manual of Style (CMS)
The Chicago Manual of Style is used largely for papers in which a teacher or professor expects there to be footnotes for each reference or citation throughout a paper. For that reason, a bibliography is often simply a recitation of the footnotes, organised alphabetically. The footnotes and bibliographical entries are not always exactly the same however. The following rules should be used for entering citations in a paper under the Chicago Style rules.

Books
Last Name, First Name. Title. Location: Publisher, Date.
Example:
Doniger, Wendy. *Splitting the Difference*. Chicago: University of Chicago Press, 1999.

Journal entries
Last Name, First Name. "Article Title." Journal Title Volume Number (Date): All Page Numbers Used in Paper
Example:
Smith, John Maynard. "The Origin of Altruism." Nature 393 (1998): 639–40.

Newspaper entries
Last Name, First Name. "Article Title." Newspaper Title, Date, Section of Paper, Edition.

Example:
Finder, Alan. "Ivy League Crunch Brings New Cache to Next Tier." New York Times, May16, 2007, Front Page, Atlantic edition.

Website entries
Website Section, "Page Title," Website Name, http://webaddress, Date accessed.
Example:
Writing Center, "Chicago/Turabian Style," The Writing Center at the University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill, http://www.unc.edu/depts/wcweb/handouts/chicago.html, Accessed 20 December 2005.



Activity 4

Imagine you have been researching information on the causes of deforestation. In your reading you used books, newspaper articles, magazines and journals. Write a bibliography which you could present at the end of your essay.



Self assessment test

1 What is documentation?
2 State any two reasons for acknowledging sources of information in academic writing.
3 Compare and contrast references and bibliography.
4 What is common between a direct quotation and a paraphrase of the same text by the same author?
5 Imagine that you have written an essay in which you have incorporated information from the sources listed below. Draw up the list of references for your essay.

Book title: Living Things
Editor: B.M. Backson
Publisher: Longman
Place of publication: London
Year of publication: 2002

Title of article: Human Rights
Author: B. Mwale
Newspaper: Daily Times
Date of publication: 20 April, 2006
Page where article found: 8

Book title: Sweet Dreams
Authors: A. Gondwe and P. Banda
Publisher: McMillan
Place of publication: New York
Year of publication: 1988



References

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Royster, J.J. & Lester, M. (Ed). (1994) *Writer's Choice: Composition and Grammar.* New York: McGraw-Hill.

Sabin, W. (1994) *The Gregg Reference Manual.* New York: Mc-Graw Hill.

Strong, W. & Lester, M. (Ed) (1996) *Writer's Choice: Grammar and Composition.* New York: McGraw-Hill.

Warren, T. (1985) *Technical Writing: Purpose, Process, and Form.* Belmont: Wadsworth.